

City of Sacramento
Law and Legislation Committee Report
915 I Street Sacramento, CA 95814
www.cityofsacramento.org

File ID: 2026-00507

3/17/2026

Discussion of an Enhanced Vacant Lot and Vacant Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

File ID: 2026-00507

Location: Citywide

Recommendation: 1) Receive a report on the City's existing vacant lot program and vacant building programs with proposed enhancements; and 2) pass a **Motion** directing staff to prepare an ordinance for an enhanced vacant lot and vacant building registration, monitoring and enforcement program.

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Presenter: Peter Lemos, Code and Housing Enforcement Chief, (916) 808-8183, plemos@cityofsacramento.org, Community Development Department

Attachments:

- 1-Description/Analysis
- 2-Proposed Vacant Lot and Building Monitoring and Enforcement
- 3-City Programs and Incentives Related to Vacant Properties
- 4-City Comparison of Registration Fees
- 5-Presentation - Vacant Properties

Description/Analysis

Issue Detail: The topic of vacant parcels and properties has been of interest in recent years due to concerns of blighted vacant properties, empty buildings and vacant storefronts, and a lack of development on vacant parcels over prolonged periods of time. The request for an enhanced vacant lot and vacant building registration, monitoring, and enforcement program has been discussed to address this citywide issue.

Enhanced Vacant Lot and Vacant Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

The City of Sacramento's Vacant Lot Program (Chapter 8.136) was adopted in 2018 to reduce blight and improve maintenance standards. The program requires annual registration, establishes nuisance

monitoring fees, and sets standards for property upkeep. The adopted ordinance did not include staffing for monitoring or enforcement of the vacant lots.

On September 16, 2025, staff brought a discussion item to the Law and Legislation Committee to request direction on amendments to an Ordinance amending section 8.136 of the Sacramento City Code relating to enforcement measures and the monitoring of vacant lots. The committee provided direction for staff to review other jurisdictions vacant lot programs, determine the staffing needed to conduct monitoring and enforcement, use the fee study to determine the full cost recovery for registration, monitoring, and administrative hearings, to shorten the time for compliance and appeals, and to provide enhanced maintenance and enforcement standards. The committee also provided direction for staff to develop a registration, monitoring, and enforcement program for vacant buildings considering all best practices and staff recommendations.

The fee study is completed, and staff have identified several areas of the municipal code that will require modification. There are currently 5,112 vacant lots identified, 460 of the lots have received an exception to the registration fee. 2,514 are registered and approximately 160 have been declared a nuisance. Over 2,000 identified vacant lots are not registered and require enforcement actions. There are currently 165 open Vacant Building cases.

A proposed enhanced vacant lot and building monitoring and enforcement program is outlined in Attachment 3. Pending direction from the Law and Legislation Committee on the level of enforcement, staff would prepare an ordinance for an enhanced vacant lot and vacant building monitoring, registration, and enforcement program and return with an outlined ordinance as directed by the Committee.

Policy Considerations: The consideration of additional incentives to develop or improve vacant properties and/or buildings is consistent with the following 2040 General Plan Policies:

- **H-1.4 Facilitate Infill Housing Development.** The City shall facilitate infill housing along commercial corridors, near employment centers, near high-frequency transit areas, and in all zones that allow residential development as a way to revitalize commercial corridors, promote walkability and increased transit ridership, and provide increased housing options.
- **LUP-4.15 Vacant Property.** The City shall develop regulations, mechanisms, programs, or incentives to facilitate the development or temporary active use of vacant buildings and property.

Economic Impacts: The requirement to register, monitor and maintain vacant properties may incentivize property owners to develop or sell the properties leading to a reduction in crime, community blight, and dangerous conditions, and could increase property values, City revenue,

economic growth, and community pride.

Environmental Considerations: The request for discussion of incentives to develop or improve vacant lots and/or buildings consists of an administrative activity such as general policy making and is not a project under the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), per Guidelines Section 15378 (b)(4) and 15378(b)(5).

Sustainability: Development of infill properties is in alignment with smart growth principles and has the potential to reduce greenhouse gas emissions due to increased proximity of housing, jobs, and services.

Commission/Committee Action: The Law and Legislation Committee, at its September 16, 2025, meeting, provided direction to staff to conduct further research on similar existing models elsewhere. The city evaluated 9 jurisdictions to look at fees and best practices and to complete the fee study to determine the cost for different levels of service. The fee study was completed to determine the cost for the city to provide the service of registration, and monitoring. The program cost will be determined by the level of service the final program requires.

At the March 7th, 2023, meeting, direction was provided to staff to look at other jurisdictions programs related to vacant lots and bring back suggestions for an enhanced ordinance.

Rationale for Recommendation: An enhanced code enforcement program has the potential to spark the economic development or activation of many vacant lots or buildings; to address blight, dangerous conditions, and safety in the community, these objectives fall within the City Council's priorities

Financial Considerations: An enhanced monitoring and enforcement program will require new and increased regulatory fees to fully offset its costs. Staff will use the fee study to determine the cost for full cost recovery for registration, monitoring, and enforcement of vacant properties.

Local Business Enterprise (LBE): Not applicable.

Enhanced Vacant Lot and Vacant Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

Current Programs and Limitations

Currently, the City has two main proactive programs that affect vacant lots: the vacant lot registration program and the weed abatement program. There is no proactive program for vacant buildings or vacant storefronts. Vacant buildings and vacant storefronts are not currently included in a registration ordinance and are only addressed when a complaint is received. This results in enforcement gaps related to blight, illegal dumping, trespassing, structural loss, illegal and immoral acts, community safety concerns, and other hazards.

The city's vacant lot registration ordinance was adopted in 2018. The registration ordinance was adopted without enforcement staffing being budgeted. As a result, inspection levels remain low due to staffing constraints and the requirement for monthly monitoring of nuisance lots.

Vacant Lot Statistics

- 5,112 vacant lots are identified citywide
- 2,514 are currently registered
- 544 receive an exemption
- Approximately 160 lots have been declared a public nuisance

The annual weed abatement program is separate from the vacant lot registration program and requires an annual notification and inspection of each lot during fire season. To reduce wildfire risk, several officers are dedicated for 3 months to inspect each vacant parcel and to conduct abatements of those lots that are a fire hazard.

Goals and Objectives of An Enhanced and Comprehensive Program

To address these challenges, staff proposes establishing an enhanced vacant property registration, monitoring, and enforcement program to:

- Increase compliance among property owners
- Identify nuisance and dangerous property earlier
- Target blight and fire risks more consistently and aggressively
- Resolve nuisance properties faster
- Reduce illegal dumping, trespassing, and chronic violations
- Stimulate economic growth and development
- Clarify code requirements for vacant properties
- Improve neighborhood appearance and community confidence in enforcement efforts
- Enable year-round enforcement beyond the current seasonal window
- Establish a clear cost recovery mechanism
- Reduce repeated responses to chronic properties by Fire, Police, and Code staff

Summary of Proposed Amendments to Sacramento City Code

Attachment 1-Proposed Vacant Lot and Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

The Enhanced Vacant property registration and Enforcement Program would include:

- Registration of all vacant properties due January 1st of each calendar year
- Definitions of vacant properties to include, lots, buildings, and storefronts.
- Clearly identified compliance requirements of each type of vacant property.
- Clear compliance and appeal periods.
- Dedicated staff for the monitoring and enforcement of nuisance vacant properties.
- A registration fee to include full cost recovery of the registration and initial inspection process.
- A flat fee for all administrative and Housing Code Advisory Appeals Boards appeals except for Notice and orders that have a higher fee as determined by the fee study.
- A monthly inspection fee to fund the program or a monthly fee for nuisance lots.
- A dedicated chapter in the municipal code to establish a vacant property ordinance.

Proposed Enhanced Vacant Property Maintenance Requirements

Vacant lots, buildings, and store fronts

- All property registrations due on January 1st of each year and a daily late fee for not registering a property after January 16th of each year.
- Requirement for the Property Owner to monitor vacant properties bi-weekly and document that the property complies with the code. Properties found in violation during an inspection will require the property owner to show documentation with timestamped photos that the property was monitored as required. Properties that were not monitored as required by code will receive a penalty.
- Response to a complaint about a vacant property that was not registered will incur a Notice and Order and a special inspection fee for the initial inspection.
- Apply the current nuisance vacant lot code for all vacant properties that fall under the nuisance vacant lot guidelines.
- Monthly monitoring fees for nuisance vacant properties to be charged for the first two years monthly monitoring fee in advance. Subsequently, monitoring fees would be billed monthly until nuisance declaration is removed.
- Nuisance complaint response fee
- New requirements for fencing of nuisance properties.
- Establish that monitoring fees and fees for notices are cost for service set by City Council and only the notice is to be appealable.

Vacant Lots

- Establish specific heights for ground cover and vegetation.
- Types of Fencing of nuisance lots
- Exempt lots found in violation twice in three years that cannot show proof of monitoring to lose all exemptions until they are no longer declared a nuisance.
- Clarify that empty lots may not be used for storage or any other non-approved use prior to City approvals.
- Set compliance and appeals period at 15 days for public nuisance violations

Vacant Buildings and Storefronts

- Establish new definitions for vacant storefronts and buildings. (what is occupied)
- Enhance building securement requirements to include:

Attachment 1-Proposed Vacant Lot and Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

- Painted boards to match building
- Properties must be sealed and secured from entry of persons and elements
- Windows above 3rd floor shall not be boarded and must be closed, secured, and in good repair with glazing
- All broken or missing exterior windows and doors shall be repaired or boarded in an approved manner
- All properties that are boarded are a nuisance property until the violations are corrected and the boards removed.
- All signage, advertising, or identifying information about a business or operation that is not currently active and in operation at that location must be removed from the vacant property. (exceptions of nuisance postings, property owner information, for sale or lease signs, declared historical signs)

Current Vacant Lot Exemptions

The following conditions are exempt from paying the registration and monitoring fees, provided they are properly registered annually and are not in violation of the Sacramento City Code and are allowed to be inspected for compliance. These exemptions would remain in place:

- Active Building Permit – Structure actively under construction
- Private Community Garden – Defined in Section 17.108.040
- Conservation Easement – Per CA Civil Code § 815.1
- Parking Lot – Defined in Section 17.108.170
- General-Use Agriculture – Defined in Section 17.108.020
- Recently Created Parcel – Subdivided in past 24 months under Title 17
- Extension of Primary Parcel – Abuts, shares ownership, and main parcel is compliant with current codes.

Program Costs and Resources

Depending on the level of proactive compliance monitoring selected, staff estimates the level of additional staffing could range from 10-25 additional staff, including code enforcement officers, building inspectors, support staff, and supervisors. Additional costs would include budgets for contractors to abate nuisances and secure buildings. Current vacant lot monitoring fees would likely increase by 50% to 100%, potentially exceeding \$600 per month per vacant property to fully offset these costs to register and monitor each property monthly.

The alternative would be to require registration and inspection of each property annually and to focus on complaint response and on properties that are declared nuisance properties, inspecting monthly with increased fees to cover staff time.

Variations of Enforcement Levels

Dedicated Enforcement Team — Inspect each property each month. (25) 22 full-time staff to conduct inspections. 3 support personnel

- Cost \$628 per property per month.

Attachment 1-Proposed Vacant Lot and Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

Registration and Initial inspection. 6 positions for initial inspection. (3 CEO & 2 HDB & 1 support)

- Lots \$690 Buildings \$887

Registration and Enforcement. (complaint response and monitoring) 10 positions (4CEO, 3HDB, 3 Supp)

- Registration \$133
- Declaration of public nuisance Lots \$1079 Buildings \$2146
- Nuisance vacant properties monitoring (24 months with the last 6 months having no violations to stop monitoring) \$557 VL & \$903 VB Per Month
- Respond to properties who fail to register. 1st 10-day Warning 2nd \$1000 3rd \$2000 & Monthly Monitoring.
- **Registration only (current)** \$133 Annually lots and buildings no dedicated enforcement add 1 support personnel

City Fees and Programs Related to Vacant Properties

The City has developed several programs and resources to incentivize the development of vacant properties, summarized below.

Enforcement Programs

- *Weed Abatement Program:* The City's Weed Abatement Program, governed by Sacramento City Code Chapter 8.28 and California Government Code Sections 39501-39502, applies to all vacant lots. Annually the City Council passes a resolution declaring that rubbish, weeds, and vegetation growing upon or in front of the 5000 plus vacant parcel(s) constitute a public nuisance and must be abated. Property owners are notified annually as a reminder and inspections occur during the fire season. Compliance is largely driven by mailings and reminders, and abatements typically occur only when there's immediate fire risk. Annually Code Enforcement abates approximately 175 lots during fire season at a cost of approximately \$250,000.00, and issues around 200 penalties.
- *Vacant Lot Program:* The City of Sacramento's Vacant Lot Program requires owners of undeveloped parcels to register each property annually, designate a local contact if they live over 35 miles away, and pay a \$70 annual fee per parcel. Additionally, the Nuisance Vacant Lot Program designates any vacant parcel with two or more administrative orders in the past 36 months as a "Nuisance Vacant Lot," with requirements such as posting a 4x4 ft sign with contact info, subjecting the lot to monthly monitoring fees (in addition to the \$70 annual fee), until the lot is either developed, approved as a community garden, or stays violation-free for two consecutive years.
- *Vacant Building Program:* The City of Sacramento's vacant building ordinance 8.100 Article XV is a Complaint driven program and cases are often closed if the property is secure and there is no exterior evidence of violations. When the owner of a vacant building fails to actively maintain and manage the building, the building can become a major cause of blight in both residential and nonresidential neighborhoods. Vacant buildings that are boarded, substandard or unkempt properties, and long-term vacancies discourage economic development and retard appreciation of property values. Some owners have acquired multiple vacant and blighted buildings at depressed prices and have not improved or cared for the properties. Currently there are approximately 165 open vacant building cases being monitored.

Incentive and Process Improvement Programs

Attachment 2-City Fees and Programs Related to Vacant Properties

- *Housing Development Toolkit:* In September 2022, the City launched an online Housing Development Toolkit that provides a one-stop resource for information on incentives, processes, and procedures to develop housing and activate vacant lots. Information about this resource was mailed to vacant lot registrants in the Summer of 2023.
- *Small Developer Incubator Program:* In 2025, the City piloted a Small Developer Incubator Program which featured multiple trainings, networking events, and open houses with the objective of providing educational resources to small and emerging developers who are looking to build missing middle housing and other smaller housing types. The City will continue to provide ongoing support to the small development community.
- *Streamline Sacramento:* Streamline Sacramento was a 2025 initiative to identify improvements to the City's development approval process with the overarching goal of increasing the supply and decreasing the cost of housing. Streamline Sacramento is a customer-driven, cross-departmental effort focusing on all aspects of the building permit process from submittal of building permit application, to plan review, issuance of building permit, inspections, and final inspection/certificate of occupancy. Streamline Sacramento is concluding with a presentation to City Council on February 24, 2026, however the work of streamlining the building permit process will be ongoing. Streamline Sacramento 2025 resulted in the completion of 29 streamlining related actions.

3- City Comparison of Registration and Monitoring Fees (Annual)

Municipality	Registration Fee VL	Registration Fee VB	Monitoring Fee	NOTES	
Sacramento	\$70	No Program	\$330		
Vallejo	\$519	\$519			
El Centro	\$50				
Rosemead	\$60			Landscaping and fencing standards	
Long Beach	\$224				
Inglewood	Single family lot \$150 Multifamily lot \$150 Commercial Lot \$250	Single Family \$150 Multifamily \$150 Commercial \$250			
Riverside County		\$70			
West Hollywood		\$740			
Pomona	\$488	\$488			
Santa Rosa	\$1040			Reg and Monitoring fee	

A dark blue silhouette of the Sacramento skyline is positioned horizontally across the middle of the slide. It features various building shapes, including several tall, rectangular skyscrapers and two prominent towers on the right side that resemble the Transamerica Pyramid. The background is a solid light blue.

Enhanced Vacant Lot and Vacant Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

March 17, 2026

Previous Law and Legislation Committee Meetings

- September 16, 2025: Initial discussion to add an enhanced Vacant Building Ordinance along with Vacant Lot Enforcement. Direction from Committee.
 - Return to L&L with enhanced models for monitoring and enforcement for both vacant buildings and vacant lots
 - Get input from stakeholders on different models.
 - Fees to cover the cost of the program

Proposed Vacant Lot and Vacant Building Monitoring and Enforcement Program

Existing Programs

Program	Purpose	Impact
Vacant Lot Registration Program	Reduce blight, ensure maintenance	• 5,115 vacant lots citywide • Owners register lots annually • Requires maintenance to avoid nuisance classification
Weed Abatement Program	Pro-active fire prevention	• Annual inspections during fire season • Focused on reducing fire hazards • Several officers dedicated for 3 months annually
Complaint-Driven Enforcement	Address issues reactively	• Illegal dumping, blight, overgrown vegetation • No proactive monthly inspections
Vacant Building Monitoring	Address issues reactively	• Monthly Monitoring • Complaint Response fee • Requires maintenance to not accrue monitoring fees • Can remain vacant if maintained

Sacramento's current approach relies heavily on annual fire-season inspections and complaint-driven enforcement — vacant buildings and storefronts are not included in existing programs.

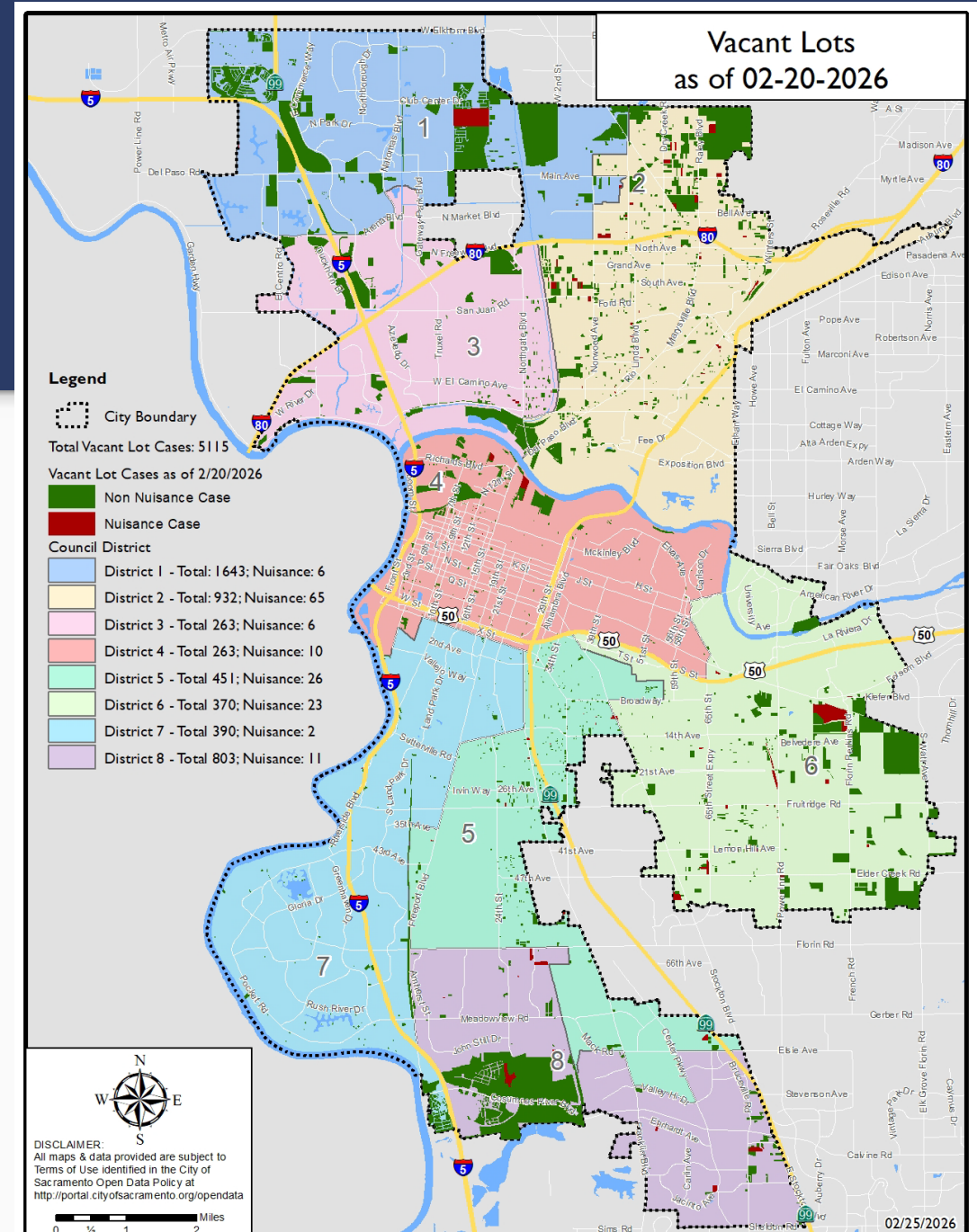
Vacant Lots by District

9/3/25 TOTAL: 4,270

- D1- 1,000
- D2- 950
- D3- 246
- D4- 270
- D5- 463
- D6- 374
- D7- 460
- D8- 507

2/20/2026 TOTAL: 5,115

- D1- 1,643 Nuisance: 6
- D2- 932 Nuisance: 65
- D3- 263 Nuisance: 6
- D4- 263 Nuisance: 10
- D5- 451 Nuisance: 26
- D6- 370 Nuisance: 23
- D7- 390 Nuisance: 2
- D8- 803 Nuisance: 11



Nuisance Vacant Lot Defined

- The Sacramento City Code defines a vacant lot as, “**A vacant lot with two or more administrative orders (including Weed Abatement Program Violations)** including but not limited to administrative penalties and orders to abate imposed in the prior 24 months is considered a Nuisance Vacant Lot and subject to additional requirements and fees.”
- A nuisance vacant lot **will remain designated as such until a community garden is installed upon the property or permitted construction of a residence/commercial building is completed upon the property or the property has remained nuisance-free for a period of 24 or more consecutive months.**

Ownership Categories

OWNER TYPE	TOTAL NUMBER	% with owner contacts outside of Sacramento County
INDIVIDUAL/TRUST/FAITH CENTER	2,207	90%
LLC/LIMITED PARTNERSHIP/INC.	2,762	74%
CITY OF SACRAMENTO/GOVERNMENT OWNED/SCHOOL DISTRICTS	143	0%

Current Exemption Categories

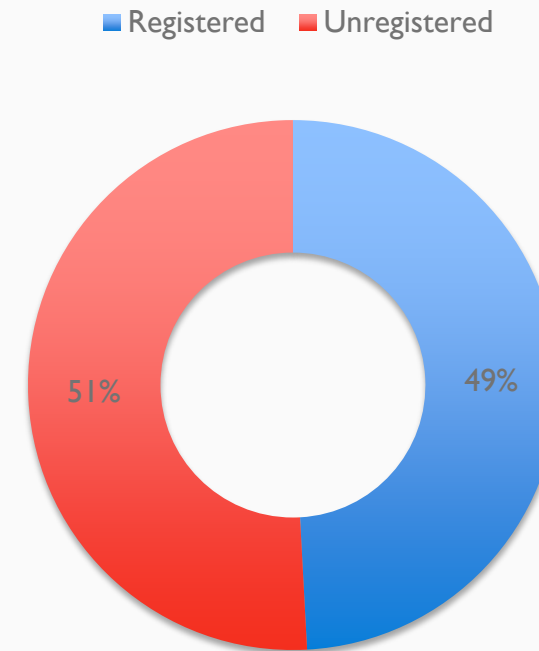
The waiver of the annual fee only applies if the property is not in violation of Chapter 8.136 and one of the following applies:

1. **A structure is being constructed** on the vacant lot under an active building permit
2. The vacant lot has a **private community garden** as defined in section [17.108.040](#);
3. The vacant lot is **subject to a conservation easement**, as defined in section 815.1 of the [California Civil Code](#);
4. The vacant lot has a **parking lot** as defined in section [17.108.170](#) of the Sacramento City Code
5. The vacant lot is being used for **general use agriculture**, as defined in section [17.108.020](#) of the Sacramento City Code
6. The vacant lot is located on a **parcel that was created within the past 24 months** pursuant to division VIII of title 17;
7. The vacant lot is **used as an extension of a primary parcel and meets all the following criteria**:
 - a) The vacant lot **abuts the primary parcel**;
 - b) The **vacant lot and the primary parcel have identical ownership**;
 - c) The primary parcel is not in violation of this code; or
8. There is an **active Urban Agriculture Incentive Zone contract**, pursuant to chapter [17.722](#), covering the vacant lot

Existing Vacant Lot Program Limitations

- **Low Compliance**
 - 5,115 vacant lots citywide (Feb. 2026)
 - Only 2,514 registered (≈49%)
 - ~300 exempt properties
- **Limited Enforcement Capacity**
 - Approx. 149 declared nuisance vacant lot
 - Approx. 165 Active vacant building cases
 - Inspections limited under current seasonal staffing model
 - No dedicated enforcement team under current ordinance
- **Gaps in Coverage**
 - Registration of vacant buildings, storefronts, and absentee owners
 - Enforcement largely complaint-driven

Compliance Feb 2026



Existing programs lack the resources and authority for consistent, proactive monitoring of vacant properties

Vacant property Registration Cost Comparison

Municipality	Registration Fee VL	Registration Fee VB
Sacramento	\$70	No Program
Vallejo	\$519	\$519
Hayward	\$2550	\$2550
Calaveras County	\$450	No Program
Long Beach	\$224	No Program
Inglewood	Single family lot \$150 Multifamily lot \$150 Commercial Lot \$250	Single Family \$150 Multifamily \$150 Commercial Lot \$250
City of Alameda	\$2905	\$2905
San Francisco	No Program	\$1850
Pomona	\$488	\$488
Santa Rosa	\$1040	\$1040

Previous Direction

Direction from March 7, 2023 Law and Legislation Committee meeting:

1. Expand the Vacant Lot Program to include vacant buildings
2. Implement a monthly inspection-based enforcement model
3. Establish a cost-recovery fee structure (full reimbursement via monitoring/registration fees)
4. Strengthen abatement authority to allow faster response to nuisance properties
5. Increase appeal fee for cost recovery of staff time.

The Enhanced Program is a direct response to Law & Legislation's 2023 direction for stronger, proactive enforcement.

Stakeholder Representatives

Sacramento Metro Chamber	Measure U Committee	Sacramento Vacancy Fee
Sacramento Association of Realtors	Sacramento Housing Alliance	House Sacramento
California Apartment Association	Strong SacTown	AIA Central Valley Chapter
Sacramento Region Business Association	Sacramento Housing & Redevelopment Agency	North State Building Industry Association
Power Inn Alliance	Sacramento Housing Policy Working Group	Thatch & Hooper, LLP

Stakeholder Feedback

I. Collaboration Opportunities

- a) Provide support to help monitor vacant properties and deter trespassing and vandalism. Improve coordination between Code Enforcement and Police on support as an incentive for vacant lot investment.
- b) Seek to find out why properties are vacant and solve for those problems
- c) Have a process to escalate a vacant property that is in violation to JFN without requiring the multi agency violation

2. Fairness & Exemptions

- a) Vacant property owners should not be penalized when market conditions do not support development.
- b) Properties with active development agreements should be exempt.
- c) Owners with entitled redevelopment plans who cannot demolish until permits are issued should be exempt.
- d) Consider escalating fees the longer a property remains vacant.

Project Timeline

1. **September 2025** → L&L Committee Review
2. **October 2025** → Draft Ordinance to City Attorney for review
3. **November/December 2025** → Outreach and Community Engagement
4. **March 2026** → Return to L&L
5. **April 2026** → To City Council for consideration
6. **May 2026** → Enact Ordinance for enhanced property maintenance standards
7. **May 2026 to December 2026** → Program Development & Setup (*staffing, systems, fee collection prep*)
8. **January 2027** → Program Launch for Property Registration

Program Costs and Resources

Depending on the level of proactive compliance monitoring selected:

1. Staffing Needs 10-25 additional staff
2. Additional costs would include budgets for contractors to abate nuisances and secure buildings
3. Current vacant lot monitoring fees would likely increase by 50% to 100%

Alternatives:

1. Respond to complaints only
2. Monitor only nuisance vacant properties
3. Respond to properties who fail to register
4. Do not include storefronts

Ensuring sustainable funding for dedicated enforcement capacity

Program Costs and Resources

- ❖ **Dedicated Enforcement Team** — Inspect each property each month. (25) 22 full-time staff to conduct inspections. 3 support personnel Cost \$628 per property per month.
- ❖ **Registration and Initial inspection.** Lots \$690 Buildings \$887 6 positions for initial inspection. (3 CEO & 2 HDB & 1 support)
- ❖ **Registration and Enforcement. (complaint response and monitoring)**
 - 10 positions (4CEO, 3HDB, 3 Supp)
 - Registration \$133
 - Declaration of Public Nuisance Lots \$1079 Buildings \$2146
 - Monitor only nuisance vacant properties (24 months of no violations to stop monitoring) \$557 VL & \$903 VB
 - Respond to properties who fail to register. 1st 10-day Warning 2nd \$1000 3rd \$2000 & Monthly monitoring.
- ❖ **Registration only (current)** \$133 annually Lots and Buildings No dedicated enforcement add 1 support personnel

Ensuring sustainable funding for dedicated enforcement capacity

Proposed Program & Code changes

1. **Unified Ordinance** → Vacant lots, buildings, and storefronts all covered
2. **Monthly Inspections** → Dedicated team, proactive year-round monitoring and enforcement
3. **Cost-Neutral Funding** → Registrations, monitoring, and appeals = full program reimbursement
4. **Registration & Renewal** → Annual (Jan 1); late penalties after Jan. 16
5. **Compliance & Appeals** → 15-day compliance and appeal (vacant lot)- and ; flat \$700 appeal fee
6. **Compliance & Appeals** → 30 Day compliance and appeal (vacant building)- and ; flat \$700 appeal fee

The Enhanced Program establishes a comprehensive, cost-neutral system for monitoring and enforcing vacant property standards.

Proposed Program & Code changes continued

- 7. **Stronger Enforcement Tools** → Declaration of Nuisance property also applied to buildings \$700, owner unappealable monitoring requirements, City-led abatements, Clarify property use and postings.
- 8. **Maintenance Standards** → Clear property maintenance, securing, and boarding standards.
- 9. **Nuisance Exempt Vacant Lots**→ Properties that qualify for exemptions, loose exemption if declared a nuisance property.
- 10. **Response Fee**→ Higher fee for complaint response to nonregistered and Non maintained properties.

The Enhanced Program establishes a comprehensive, cost-neutral system for monitoring and enforcing vacant property standards.

Leveraging Technology

1. GIS team is working to strengthen the current Weed Abatement App to create an interactive field maps for Code Officers completing compliance checks on Vacant Lots/Buildings.
2. Clariti, the new case management software, will allow for customer facing portals with transparent statuses on Vacant Lots/Buildings and clear options for Vacant Lot/Buildings program uses and ease of registration or waiver submissions.

Questions and Discussion



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